

“Everyone already analyzes driver risk.” True. Here’s who they work for.

Three parties touch a fleet’s driver data today. None of them is on the fleet’s side of the renewal table.

WHO	WHAT THEY ACTUALLY DO	WHO THEY WORK FOR	WHAT THEY WILL NEVER DO
The telematics platform (Samsara, Motive...)	Detects events, sends threshold alerts, and offers a driver score the fleet can configure itself — Samsara’s Safety Score, Motive’s Safety Score, Geotab’s Safety Scorecard. Detection and measurement — done well.	The software vendor. Its revenue is the software subscription, so the product’s job ends at detecting and reporting — demonstrating the software works. What happens to the fleet’s insurance bill after that is nobody’s performance metric.	Turn detection into a coaching program with documented results. Northland’s May 2026 survey of 300 fleet risk managers: 43% of small fleets and 49% of mid-sized ones can’t convert telematics insights into effective coaching or measurable safety improvement — alerts pile up, behavior doesn’t change, and none of it reaches the renewal file.
The insurer’s safety / loss-control team	Analyzes the account’s risk — accurately. Runs inspections and loss-control visits.	The insurance company. Their analysis exists to price the risk and protect the carrier’s loss ratio.	Build the fleet’s case for a <i>lower</i> premium — that would be negotiating against their own employer. And their work stays with that one carrier: it doesn’t travel when the account is shopped to other markets.
The fleet’s safety person (at 10–100 trucks)	Usually the owner or a dispatcher wearing a second hat. Responds to the worst alerts when there’s time.	The fleet — but part-time, between dispatch and payroll.	Sustain the analysis — and this is measured, not assumed: 66% of fleets name <i>interpreting or acting on</i> telematics data as their top challenge with the technology, ranked above privacy and accuracy concerns (SambaSafety, Oct 2025), and roughly a third of small fleets have no formal safety program at all. The data gets collected; the analyst-hours to weight it, trend it, and write it in the language underwriters use to grant credits are what no one at this size has.
Discern Verity	Takes the data the platform already collects and turns it into scored drivers, a documented coaching program, and an underwriter-ready renewal packet.	The fleet. Only the fleet. Paid by no platform, no carrier, no commission.	—

The difference in one sentence

An alert tells the fleet a driver had too many events. A renewal packet **proves — in underwriter language — that the fleet found its risk, coached it, and fixed it.** One is a notification; the other is negotiating leverage.

Or the shorter version: **a smoke alarm is not a fire-prevention program** — and the fire marshal’s inspection report, however accurate, was never written to lower your insurance bill.

What the packet contains that neither the alerts nor the insurer will ever produce

- 1. A score built for the negotiation, not the dashboard.** To be precise about what the platforms do: Samsara, Motive, and Geotab all offer per-mile driver scores — with *weights the fleet configures itself*. That’s useful for internal monitoring, but in a renewal it’s self-graded homework: a score whose weights the insured can tune to look better carries no independent authority. The packet’s weights are fixed, tied to claim severity, disclosed up front, and applied identically all year — evidence a third party stands behind.
- 2. Documented coaching with before-and-after evidence** — the difference between telling an underwriter “we coach our drivers” and showing a driver’s measured improvement over a quarter.
- 3. Context the alerts don’t see** — where and when risk concentrates (specific corridors, night runs), so the fleet fixes scheduling and routing, not just drivers.
- 4. A consistent, dated methodology running all year** — what underwriters credit is a program, not a spreadsheet assembled the week before renewal.
- 5. Portability.** The insurer’s safety work stays with the insurer. The packet belongs to the fleet — it goes to *every* market the broker shops, and it’s just as persuasive at the incumbent as at a competitor.

Why this matters to the broker specifically

- The insurer’s analysis prices the risk. This packet argues it.** Those are opposite jobs — a broker with only the carrier’s view walks into the negotiation with the other side’s numbers.
- When you shop an account across your markets, the carrier’s loss-control file doesn’t come with you.** The packet does — the same documentation works at every quote.
- A fleet that sees its own data working stays put.** The account that renews with a documented safety story doesn’t take the next broker’s cold call.

When the insurer resists: “We have our own score”

Expect this from underwriters — and the move is the same one: **agree, then reframe**. The packet is not a rival score; it’s input to a decision their own rating plan already lets them make.

1. **“You do — and I’m not asking you to replace it.”** Schedule rating exists precisely for what the carrier’s model can’t see: driver quality, safety organization, management cooperation. Those credits are discretionary and documentation-triggered — an underwriter can’t grant them on a fleet’s word. The packet is the paperwork that unlocks a decision the underwriter is *already allowed to make*. Nothing about their model has to move.
2. **“Your model looks backward. This looks forward.”** Loss-rated accounts are priced on 3–5 years of history. The packet shows current behavior and its trend — the fleet that had one bad claim year but has measurably improved since is exactly the account where history overprices the risk and documentation corrects it. That’s not a flaw in the carrier’s model; it’s the one thing no loss run can contain.
3. **“The market has already voted on this data.”** Progressive, Northland, Nationwide, and the newer trucking insurers (Nirvana, HDVI, Cover Whale) all pay for, discount on, or price with exactly this telematics data. The question is no longer whether driver data moves premium — only whether this carrier prices the improved risk, or a competitor does.
4. **The quiet leverage: the packet travels.** Never said as a threat — the broker simply shops it. If the incumbent won’t recognize documented improvement, the identical packet sits in front of every other market’s underwriter the same week. One desk’s resistance isn’t a dead end; it’s the broker’s reason to go to market.

The one-liner: *“I’m not grading your model’s homework. I’m handing your underwriter the file they need to use the discretion they already have.”*

Independence, in plain terms: Discern Verity is paid by the fleet only — no software commissions, no carrier appointments, no share of anyone’s premium. That’s not a limitation; it’s the product. Analysis you can trust is analysis from someone with nothing to gain from the answer.

Discern Verity · Independent fleet-safety analytics · Chicago, IL

Sources

- Samsara Help Center, “Safety Score Categories and Calculation” — per-behavior weights, normalized per 1,000 miles / drive time, fleet-configurable
- Motive Help Center, “Motive Safety Score” — events per 1,000 miles, 4-week rolling window, configurable weights, thresholds, and performance ranges
- Geotab Support Center, “Driver Safety Scorecard” — 0–100 score on six exception rules with customizable rule weights
- Northland Insurance (Travelers) survey of 300 small/mid-fleet risk managers, May 2026 — reported by Business Fleet and Insurance Business
- SambaSafety 2025 Telematics Report (Oct 2025) — 66% of fleets cite interpreting/acting on data as a top telematics challenge, reported by Trucking Dive
- Automotive Fleet — one-third of small fleets report having no formal safety program